

Story Structure

Grade 3 Stories & Fables

Read the story. Then label each part with its plot stage.

The Broken Kite

Tom and his dad built a big blue kite on Saturday morning. They glued the sticks, tied the string, and added a long red tail. At the park, the wind was just right. Up went the kite, higher and higher! Then Tom heard a snap. The string had broken! The kite sailed away and landed in a tall tree. Tom felt like crying. Just then a strong wind shook the tree. The kite fell, but it tore on a branch on the way down. Dad patted Tom's shoulder. They took the kite home. Dad taped the tear and tied on a stronger string. Back at the park, the mended kite flew higher than ever. Tom cheered.

Label each part: I=introduction, P=problem, C=climax, R=resolution

_____ The wind shakes the kite loose, but it tears on a branch.

_____ Tom and his dad build a blue kite.

_____ Dad tapes the tear and they fly the kite together.

_____ The string snaps and the kite lands in a tree.

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The Lost Puppy

Sara got a tiny puppy for her birthday. She named him Biscuit because of his golden fur. Biscuit followed Sara everywhere. One morning Dad left the garden gate open. Biscuit squeezed through and ran down the street! Sara called and called, but Biscuit did not come back. She felt tears in her eyes. She walked down the street, looking behind every bush. Then she heard a soft bark behind the big green bush. There was Biscuit, wagging his tail! Sara hugged him tight. She led him home and shut the gate. From that day on, Sara always checked the gate before playing outside.

Label each part: I=introduction, P=problem, C=climax, R=resolution

_____ Sara hears barking behind the big bush.

_____ She finds Biscuit and brings him home.

_____ Biscuit runs out through the open gate.

_____ Sara gets a puppy named Biscuit.

Story Structure

Grade 4 Stories & Fables

Read the story. Then label each part with its plot stage.

The Flooded Garden

Mr. Rao loved his garden. In spring he planted tomato seeds, carrot seeds, and beans. He watered them every evening and watched the first green shoots appear. Then the rains came. It rained for three whole days. Water covered the garden paths. Mr. Rao worried the seeds would rot. On the fourth day the sun came out. The water slowly drained away into the ditch. Mr. Rao walked out to look. Tiny green sprouts were pushing up everywhere! The plants had survived. By summer the garden was full of red tomatoes and orange carrots. Mr. Rao shared them with all his neighbors.

Label each part: I=introduction, P=problem, C=climax, R=resolution

_____ The sun comes out and the water drains away.

_____ New sprouts grow, and the garden is saved.

_____ Mr. Rao plants seeds in his garden.

_____ Heavy rain floods the garden for three days.

Story Structure

Grade 4 Stories & Fables

Read the story. Then label each part with its plot stage.

The Spelling Bee

Asha wanted to win the school spelling bee. Every night she practiced words with her mother. She learned tricky words like though and beautiful. On the big day the hall was full. Asha spelled word after word correctly. Then came the word rhythm. Asha spelled it wrong. Her heart sank. But the contest went on, and soon only two spellers were left. For second place, Asha had to spell the word friend. She took a deep breath and spelled it perfectly! She won second place. Asha smiled proudly. Next year, she told her mother, I will win first.

Label each part: I=introduction, P=problem, C=climax, R=resolution

_____ She spells the last word right to win second place.

_____ Asha practices spelling every night.

_____ She misses a word in the spelling bee.

_____ She is proud and plans to try again next year.

Story Structure

Grade 5 Stories & Fables

Read the story. Then label each part with its plot stage.

The Lighthouse Light

Old Tomas had tended the lighthouse for forty years. Each evening he polished the great lamp until it shone like a second moon. One wild night a storm struck the coast. Wind howled and waves smashed the rocks. Suddenly the lamp went dark! The oil line had broken. Tomas grabbed a spare lantern and climbed the winding tower stairs. The wind shook the tower, but he kept climbing. At the top he lit the lantern and held it high in the lamp room. Its beam cut through the storm. Far below, a small ship turned away from the rocks. By morning the storm had passed. The sailors rowed ashore to thank Tomas. Your light saved our ship, they said. Tomas just smiled and began to polish the lamp again.

Label each part: I=introduction, P=problem, C=climax, F=falling action, R=resolution

_____ Tomas climbs the tower with a spare lantern.

_____ Old Tomas tends the lighthouse.

_____ The sailors thank Tomas the next morning.

_____ The lamp goes out during a storm.

_____ The light shines again and the ship turns away.

Story Structure

Grade 5 Stories & Fables

Read the story. Then label each part with its plot stage.

The New Student

Nina moved to a new town in October. Everything was strange: the streets, the school, the faces. On her first day she sat alone at lunch, pushing her sandwich around her plate. She missed her old friends. During break a boy dropped his books in the hallway. Papers flew everywhere. Nina knelt down and helped him pick them up. Thanks, he said with a grin. I'm Leo. They started talking about books and games. They laughed at the same jokes. At lunch the next day, Leo waved her over to his table. Nina sat down, smiling. She had made her first new friend.

Label each part: I=introduction, P=problem, C=climax, F=falling action, R=resolution

- _____ They talk and laugh together.
- _____ She feels shy and eats lunch alone.
- _____ Nina moves to a new town.
- _____ Nina makes her first new friend.
- _____ She helps a boy who drops his books.

Story Structure

Grade 4 Stories & Fables

Read each text. Circle why the author wrote it.

Authors write for a reason. Circle the author's purpose for each text.

entertain = tell a story | inform = teach facts

persuade = change your mind | explain how = teach steps

1. Pop! The corn jumped in the hot pan. Sara laughed as the kernels danced. Soon the bowl was full of fluffy popcorn.

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

2. Frogs lay eggs in water. The eggs hatch into tadpoles. Tadpoles grow legs and become frogs.

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

3. You should turn off the tap while you brush. Saving water helps our town. Start today!

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

4. First, wet your hands. Next, add soap and rub. Then rinse well. Last, dry with a towel.

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

5. The moon wore a silver hat. It danced with the sleepy stars. Then it yawned and went to bed.

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

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1. The old ship creaked in the storm. Waves as tall as houses crashed over the deck. Captain Lee held the wheel tight.

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

2. Volcanoes are openings in the earth. Hot rock called lava flows out. When lava cools, it makes new rock.

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

3. Our park needs more trees. Trees give shade and clean air. Join us on Saturday to plant ten new trees!

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

4. To plant a seed, dig a small hole. Drop in the seed and cover it with soil. Water it every day.

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

5. Bees buzzed in the clover. The sun smiled down. It was the perfect summer morning.

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

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1. Ben's dog dug a hole to China. Instead he found a bone, a shoe, and one very surprised worm.

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

2. Ants live in groups called colonies. Each ant has a job. Some find food and some guard the nest.

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

3. Reading every day makes you smarter. Visit the library this week and pick a great book!

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

4. First fold the paper in half. Then fold the corners to make wings. Last, throw your plane gently.

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

5. The rain sang on the roof. Puddles clapped. Thunder drummed along.

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

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1. Maya opened the dusty trunk. Inside lay a map with a red X. Her heart beat fast. An adventure was waiting!

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

2. The heart pumps blood through the body. Blood carries air to every part. Exercise keeps the heart strong.

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

3. Litter hurts animals. Please use the bins at the beach. A clean beach is a happy beach!

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

4. Mix flour, sugar, and eggs in a bowl. Stir well. Pour into a pan and bake for twenty minutes.

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how

5. Snowflakes twirled like dancers. The world turned white and quiet. Winter had arrived.

entertain

inform

persuade

explain how